

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 862

By Sexton

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Natalie Leach Haslam of Knoxville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Natalie Leach Haslam; and

WHEREAS, Natalie Leach Haslam was a beloved Tennessean whose life of service, generosity, and civic leadership left an indelible mark on her community, her alma mater, and the cultural life of this State; and

WHEREAS, born in 1931 to Dr. Robert Swepson and Jennie Belle Boyden, Natalie Haslam was raised in the Sequoyah Hills neighborhood of Knoxville and remained a lifelong parishioner of St. John's Cathedral; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Haslam graduated from the University of Tennessee (UT) in 1952 with a degree in liberal arts and was named Miss Tennessee 1951–1952 during her time as a student; she remained a devoted supporter of the university throughout her life, and in 2024, the College of Music was named in her honor in recognition of her extraordinary commitment to the arts and higher education; and

WHEREAS, Natalie Haslam gave generously of her time and resources in service to numerous civic and cultural organizations, including the Knoxville Symphony Society, East Tennessee Foundation, East Tennessee Historical Society, Knoxville Garden Club, Arts and Cultural Alliance of Greater Knoxville, Friends of the Great Smoky Mountains National Park, Tennessee Arts Commission, Zoo Knoxville, Maryville College, Child and Family Services, the Wellness Community, the Webb School of Knoxville, and the Junior League of Knoxville; and

WHEREAS, at her alma mater, Mrs. Haslam served on the Library Society Board, College of Arts and Sciences Board of Visitors, Friends of the UT Gardens, UT Chancellor's

Circle, Chancellor's Associates, and UT Alliance of Women Philanthropists Executive Board;
and

WHEREAS, a devoted supporter of the arts, Mrs. Haslam was the first woman to serve as president of the Knoxville Symphony Orchestra, and her generosity helped shape the region's artistic and educational landscape for future generations; and

WHEREAS, in recognition of her enduring service and civic contributions, Natalie Haslam was named the University of Tennessee's Volunteer of the Year in 1992 and, alongside her husband, Jim Haslam, was named a Distinguished Alumnus of the university in 2009; she was also recognized as East Tennessean of the Year by the East Tennessee Historical Society in 2018; and

WHEREAS, above all else, Mrs. Haslam was deeply devoted to her family; she is survived by her loving husband of fifty years, James A. "Jim" Haslam II; daughters, Jennie (Rob) McCabe, Susan (Chip) Robie, and Carol Pattison; stepchildren, Jimmy (Dee) Haslam, Ann Haslam (Steve) Bailey, and Governor Bill (Crissy) Haslam; and her grandchildren and great-grandchildren, all of whom brought her great pride and joy; and

WHEREAS, Natalie Haslam leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we pause to remember the bountiful life of this remarkable woman, whose compassion, vision, and dedication to service enriched the lives of so many; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Natalie Leach Haslam, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character, her lifetime of leadership and generosity, and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mrs. Haslam.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.